

Theo Serlin

Contact Details

Bush House North East Wing, 30 Aldwych, London WC2B 4BG
theo-serlin.github.io | theo.serlin@kcl.ac.uk

Employment

KING'S COLLEGE LONDON, London, UK
Lecturer (Assistant Professor), Department of Political Economy, 2025–
PRINCETON UNIVERSITY, Princeton, NJ
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Niehaus Center, 2024–2025

Education

STANFORD UNIVERSITY, Stanford, CA
Ph.D in Political Science, 2019–2024
MA in Economics, 2019–2022
HARVARD UNIVERSITY, Cambridge, MA
AB in History, *summa cum laude*, 2015–2018

Publications

“The Public Agglomeration Effect: Urban-Rural Divisions in Government Efficiency and Political Preferences,” Forthcoming, *American Journal of Political Science*
“Trains, Trade, and Transformation: A Spatial Rogowski Theory of America’s 19th Century Protectionism,” with Kenneth Scheve, 2025, *American Journal of Political Science* 69 (3): 915–929
“The German Trade Shock and the Rise of the Neo-Welfare State in Early Twentieth-Century Britain,” with Kenneth Scheve, 2023, *American Political Science Review* 117 (2): 557–574

Working Papers

“Market Power and Distorted Democracy in the Progressive Era,” with Kenneth Scheve and Sydney White, 2026
“Buying Followers: The Political Consequences of the Twitter Acquisition,” with Chenoa Yorgason, 2026
“Migration and the Making of the English Middle Class,” with Vasiliki Fouka, 2026
“Lobbying and Legislative Representation,” with Hye Young You, 2025
“How Polarization Ends,” with Avidit Acharya and Alexander Lee, 2025
“Gravity’s Politics,” 2024. Revise and resubmit at *International Organization*.
“Industry and Identity: The Migration Linkage Between Economic and Cultural Change,” with Vasiliki Fouka, 2023
“The Export Boom and the Backlash: Reactions to Positive Economic Change in First World War America,” 2022

In Progress

“Protection by Covariance,” with Hye Young You, 2026

Talks

UCL, Cologne, 2026

King's College London, MIT, Princeton, Rochester, 2025

Peking University, King's College London, 2024

Emory, UC Berkeley, Princeton, NYU, Yale, Duke, Texas A&M, Notre Dame, Stanford, 2023

Conferences

LSE-Penn The Global Economy and the United States in a Changing World Order (discussant), King's Early Career Workshop in Quantitative Political Economy (discussant), LSE Political Dimensions of Place-Based Inequalities in Urban & Rural Life (discussant), 2026

Copenhagen Business School Money in Politics, NBER Economics of Culture and Institutions, 2025

Peking University Symposium on Institutions and Development, 2024 (discussant)

APSA annual meetings, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

EPSA annual meeting, 2025

IPES annual meetings, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Teaching

King's College London

6SSPP383 Advanced Economics of Politics (undergraduate), Fall 2025

5SSPP245 Statistics for History and Political Economy (undergraduate), Fall 2025

Stanford

PS 356a Formal Theory I (Ph.D), TA for James Fearon, Winter 2021, TA for Avidit Acharya, Winter 2022

PS 356b Formal Theory II (Ph.D), TA for Amanda Kennard, Spring 2021

PS 450a Political Methodology I (Ph.D), TA for Jens Hainmueller, Fall 2022

PS 150a Data Science for Politics (undergraduate), TA for Alain Schlaepfer, Fall 2021

Political Science Ph.D Math Camp, TA for Alain Schlaepfer, Fall 2022

Awards and Grants

Data Driven Social Science Initiative, Princeton University, 2025. Research grant, \$4,925, with Jeongmin Park

David A. Lake Award, 2022. Best paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Political Economy Society, for "The Export Boom and the Backlash"

George P. Shultz Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research, 2022. Research grant, \$7,500

Sophia Freund Prize, Harvard College, 2018. Best academic record among graduating students

Department of History Prize, 2018. Best academic record among graduating students in the Department of History

Thomas T. Hoopes Prize, 2018. University wide senior thesis prize

Phi Beta Kappa, 2017

Service

Mentor, Stanford Political Science Pathways to Ph.D Program, 2021, 2022

Referee, *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *International Organization*, *Journal of Economic Inequality*, *Review of International Organizations*, *Review of International Political Economy*, *Social Choice and Welfare*, *World Politics*

Professional Experience SANFORD C. BERNSTEIN & CO., New York, NY

Research Associate, 2018–2019

References

Kenneth Scheve, I.A. O'Shaughnessy Dean, Professor of Political Science, University of Notre Dame, kscheve@nd.edu

Avidit Acharya, Professor of Political Science, Stanford University, avidit@stanford.edu

Vasiliki Fouka, Associate Professor of Political Science, Stanford University, vfouka@stanford.edu

Jonathan Rodden, Professor of Political Science, Stanford University, jrodde@stanford.edu

Last updated June 12, 2026